

PROJECT STATUS UPDATE

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Mixed Tenses Writing - B1+ / B2

Situation

You are part of a web development team working on a project for a client. Before the weekly meeting, your team leader asks you to write a short project status update.

Your task

Write **150-180 words in four paragraphs**. Use the verb tenses that best fit your ideas. Do not try to use every tense from the unit.

1. THE PROJECT NOW

What is the project? What does your team normally do?
What are you working on now?

Present Simple / Present Continuous

2. PROGRESS SO FAR

What have you completed? What is still unfinished? How long have you been working on something?

Present Perfect / Present Perfect Continuous

3. A RECENT PROBLEM

What happened? What were you doing? What had happened before? How did you solve it?

Past Simple / Past Continuous / Past Perfect

4. NEXT STEPS

What is arranged? What are your plans? What do you expect to complete before the deadline?

Future forms

GRAMMAR TARGET

Your writing must include: **one present tense, one Present Perfect form, one past tense, one future form, and at least five different verb forms in total.**

B2 challenge: use six or more different forms and include at least one naturally: Present Perfect Continuous, Past Perfect, Future Continuous or Future Perfect.

Before you write

- 1** Choose a project | **2** Decide what is happening now | **3** Choose one recent problem
4 Decide the next steps and deadline

Use the model for structure and language, but create your own situation. Write notes first - not full sentences.

Idea bank

PROJECT

shop / portfolio
school site / booking
app

CURRENT WORK

homepage / database
login / mobile
accessibility

PROBLEM

server / database
login / files
display

NEXT

testing / meeting
redesign / security
new feature

Plan your ideas

Project

Problem

Current task

Cause / solution

Progress

Next steps

Unfinished

Deadline

Remember: your project, problem and future plans must be different from the model. Aim for at least **five different verb forms**, including present, Present Perfect, past and future.

Model answer

Our team is currently developing an online booking system for a hotel. **In general**, we divide the work between front-end and back-end tasks, but **at the moment** we are focusing on the reservation page and the mobile version.

So far, we have completed the homepage, the room catalogue and the contact section. **However**, we haven't finished the payment system yet because we have been dealing with a security issue for the last few days. **Apart from that**, the project is progressing well.

Yesterday, we had a problem with the booking form. **While** I was testing it, the website suddenly stopped saving new reservations. **After checking the system**, we discovered that a database setting had been changed by mistake. **Fortunately**, we had a recent backup, so we restored the previous configuration and solved the problem.

As for the next steps, we are meeting the client tomorrow to discuss a few final changes. **After that**, we are going to start the final testing phase. **If everything goes according to plan**, by the end of next week we will have completed the main version of the website.

Model: 184 words

Connector bank - choose what fits your paragraph

1. NOW

In general · usually · normally · at the moment · currently · while

2. PROGRESS

So far · up to now · however · also · in addition · apart from that · yet

3. PROBLEM

recently · yesterday · while · when · after · before · fortunately · eventually · as a result

4. NEXT

as for the next steps · after that · then · next · in the meantime · if everything goes according to plan · by...

Think about **WHEN** the action happens first. Then choose the tense.

Do not force a difficult tense just because it appears in the grammar list. **B2:** use 6+ forms and include one naturally: Present Perfect Continuous, Past Perfect, Future Continuous or Future Perfect.

Essential tips

1. Follow the four-paragraph structure.

2. Use connectors, but do not overuse them.

3. Avoid starting every sentence with *We...*

4. Use specific web-development vocabulary.

5. Check time expressions: yesterday, since, for, yet, at the moment, by Friday.

6. Re-read for verb forms, spelling and punctuation.

Write your final version here

Name	Raúl	Group	2ºDAW Y	Date	5/10/2026
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Project Status Update

Write **150-180 words** in four paragraphs. Use your notes from page 1. You may use the model as a language guide, but your content must be your own.

Our team normally builds custom templates for online stores, and we are currently developing an e-commerce website for a local sports shop. At the moment, we are working on the product database and the user login system.

So far, we have successfully designed the homepage and the shopping cart interface. However, we haven't integrated the payment gateway yet because we have been trying to resolve an API connection issue for the last two days. Apart from that, the progress is fantastic.

Yesterday, we experienced a major problem with the main server. While I was uploading new high-resolution product images, the testing website suddenly crashed. After a quick technical check, we discovered that someone had deleted a core configuration file by mistake. Fortunately, we restored the backup quickly and solved it.

As for the next steps, we are having a meeting with the client on Friday to review the interface design. After that, we are going to begin the security testing phase. If everything goes according to plan, by the end of this month we will have launched the final version of the store.

Final check

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|---|--|
| ☐ 150-180 words | ☐ Connectors link my ideas clearly |
| ☐ 4 clear paragraphs | ☐ Specific web-development vocabulary |
| ☐ 5+ different verb forms, including present, Present Perfect, past and future | ☐ My ideas are different from the model's |
| | ☐ Spelling and punctuation checked |